SUMS

INTERNAL MID-REPORT

ST.XAVIER'S COLLEGE

2081

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

01

STAKEHOLDERS

SUMS

SUMS Nepal Private Limited is a pioneering company dedicated to empowering educational institutes by providing comprehensive learning tools, facilitating training and workshops, and fostering international project connections. Specializing in bridging local and international collaborations, SUMS Nepal serves as a facilitator for institutes looking to enhance their educational offerings and global exposure. The company excels in delivering cutting-edge learning solutions, offering tailored training programs, and seamlessly connecting institutes with diverse international projects.

SUMS Nepal's commitment lies in fostering a dynamic and globally connected educational ecosystem, ensuring that institutes receive the tools and support needed to thrive in the ever-evolving landscape of education. We seamlessly connect students' innovation from the companies, unleashing a synergy that propels projects to new heights. Benefit from fresh perspectives, innovative ideas, and cost-effective solutions, as SUMS empowers Academic Institutes to build and thrive with the energy and expertise of tomorrow's leaders as well as connect to international sphere.

ST. XAVIER'S COLLEGE, Kathmandu, is an educational institution of higher learning established and managed by the Nepal Jesuit Society. The Jesuits began their educational work in Nepal in 1951 with the opening of St. Xavier's School, Godavari, followed by St. Xavier's School, Jawalakhel, St. Xavier's School, Deonia, Moran Memorial School, Maheshpur,and St. Xavier's School, Sadakbari.The Jesuits have served people of all faiths, all over the world, as educators, scientists, explorers and social reformers since 1540. The centuries-old tradition of service to others is the cornerstone of Jesuit education. Every institute and organization established by the Jesuits in Nepal, prepares each student to Live for God and Lead for Nepal.

The education programme is designed to foster criticalthinking, positive action and service to others. It challenges students to look beyond career, and have a wider vision of being channels of betterment. It encourages every student to be a job creator rather than a job seeker, and to play the role of being a creative designer of the future.vel, bachelor level and also for XI & XII with their up-dated knowledge.

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02

OVERVIEW OF PRE-INCUBATION

The pre-incubation model focuses on empowering aspiring innovators by equipping them with essential skills, **validating their ideas**, and **fostering entrepreneurial mindsets**. Participants undergo targeted training in areas such as **problem-solving, market research,** and **pitching**, enabling them to refine their concepts into viable solutions. With a balanced male-to-female participation ratio, the program emphasizes inclusivity and diverse perspectives.

This model acts as a bridge between ideation and implementation, ensuring validated ideas are ready to progress into live projects with clear roadmaps and strategic support. It is designed to create a sustainable pipeline for innovation and entrepreneurship.

03

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS AND HIGHLIGHTS OF THE PROGRAM

- Participants demonstrated measurable improvement in entrepreneurial and problem-solving skills
- Workshop sessions and engagement focused in Teamwork, Design Thinking, Customer Profiles and Research of users based on Data
- Diverse contributions and perspectives
- Participants reported increased confidence in their ability to execute their ideas
- Positive feedback on program structure, particularly hands-on workshops and real-world simulations.

04

STRATEGIC DIRECTION AND NEXT MILESTONES

- Clear action plans established for transitioning validated ideas to the live implementation phase (Ideathon, MVP, TestBED, Incubation, Hackathon & Accelerator)
- Mentorship from International Industry Expertise to support the ideas and concept of the solution developed by students
- Strategic partnerships initiated with industry stakeholders to provide further support and networking
- Built a collaborative ecosystem of innovators, mentors, and industry experts
- Enhanced regional innovation capacity, with participants keen to address local and global challenges

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INTRODUCTION

Background and purpose of the pre-incubation program

Client's role and interest in the initiative

Alignment with organizational goals and market opportunities

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BACKGROUND AND PURPOSE OF THE PRE-INCUBATION PROGRAM

In Nepal, where untapped talent and innovation potential coexist with limited entrepreneurial support structures, the pre-incubation program organized by SUMS Nepal in collaboration with St.Xavier's College was a crucial initiative aimed at bridging this gap. The program was designed to nurture aspiring entrepreneurs, empower them with essential skills, and validate innovative ideas capable of addressing local and global challenges.

Despite a growing interest in entrepreneurship among Nepalese youth, many face significant barriers such as inadequate access to training, mentorship, and resources. This program served as a launchpad for innovation, offering structured support to equip participants with competencies in areas like problem-solving, market research, digital transformation, and sustainable business practices.

1

Unlocking Potential

Nepal's youthful demographic represents a goldmine of creativity and ambition. This program aimed to channel that energy into actionable solutions, contributing to economic growth and employment generation.

2

Building Entrepreneurial Ecosystems

By combining academic expertise from St.Xavier's College with real-world experience facilitated by SUMS Nepal, the initiative fostered an ecosystem where learning, innovation, and collaboration thrived.

3

Fostering Inclusivity and Diversity

With a deliberate focus on gender equity and diverse participation, the program created a platform where ideas could flourish, regardless of background or resources.

4

Catalyzing Change

The pre-incubation program was not just about ideation; it laid a foundation for long-term impact, creating pathways for participants to move from concept to execution. This aligns with Nepal's aspirations for sustainable development and global competitiveness.

5

Addressing Local Needs with Global Relevance

Rooted in the realities of Nepal's socio-economic landscape, the ideas emerging from the program were tailored to solve pressing challenges while having the potential to scale internationally.

This pre-incubation program wasn't merely a training initiative; it was a strategic intervention to ignite Nepal's entrepreneurial spirit and position its innovators as drivers of change. By fostering creativity, validating ideas, and empowering participants with actionable skills, SUMS Nepal and St.Xavier's College have set the stage for a future where Nepal's entrepreneurs lead the way in innovation and impact.

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ST.XAVIER'S COLLEGE'S ROLE AND INTEREST IN THE INITIATIVE

St.Xavier's College, known for its commitment to fostering academic and professional excellence, played a pivotal role in the pre-incubation program. The institution's focus on bridging the gap between academic learning and industry needs aligns seamlessly with the goals of such entrepreneurial initiatives.

With a strong emphasis on practical, career-oriented education, St.Xaviers aims to cultivate graduates who are not only academically proficient but also prepared to excel in the global market. This vision has driven their involvement in programs like the pre-incubation workshop, which fosters entrepreneurship, innovation, and skill development. Their collaboration highlights a keen interest in nurturing entrepreneurial mindsets among students and empowering them with the tools and networks necessary for business success.

St.Xavier's College also brings its expertise in hosting skill-oriented events, that provides hands-on training and competency assessments. This aligns perfectly with the program's goals of equipping participants with actionable skills and validated business ideas. Their collaboration with partners like the University Grants Commission and other academic bodies underscores their commitment to creating a robust ecosystem for young entrepreneurs in Nepal, showcasing their capacity to influence and enhance educational outcomes.

Their vested interest in this program reflects a broader strategy to strengthen ties with industry leaders, foster innovation, and address regional challenges such as unemployment and skill gaps while building a sustainable future for entrepreneurial youth in Nepal.

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ALIGNMENT WITH ORGANIZATIONAL GOALS AND MARKET OPPORTUNITIES

The pre-incubation program aligns directly with the strategic objectives of both SUMS Nepal and St.Xavier's College, while capitalizing on pressing market opportunities in Nepal's entrepreneurial ecosystem.

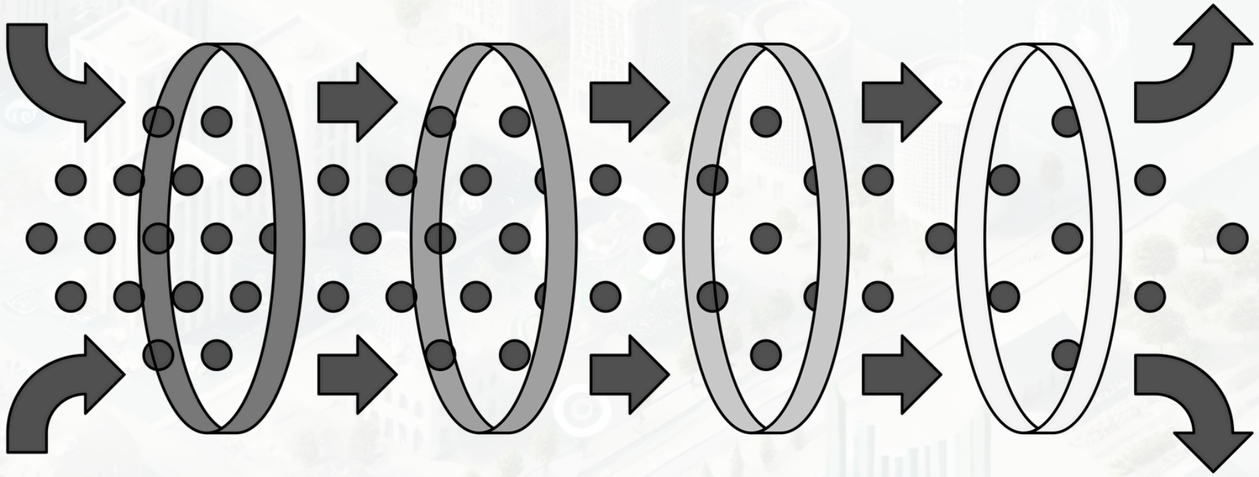
- **Fostering Entrepreneurial Ecosystems**:Both organizations emphasize creating platforms that bridge the gap between academic knowledge and industry demands. This program advances their shared vision of equipping students with skills that translate into tangible career and business opportunities, particularly in underdeveloped entrepreneurial sectors.

- **Addressing Market Needs:**Nepal's emerging market shows significant demand for innovative solutions in sectors like technology, education, and sustainability. The program supports these opportunities by validating ideas that are both locally impactful and scalable. By empowering youth to transform ideas into viable enterprises, it directly contributes to reducing unemployment and enhancing economic resilience.

- **Future-Ready Graduates:** St.Xavier's College, the program supports their mission of preparing students to excel in competitive global markets. By aligning education with entrepreneurial skills, they enable students to become job creators, not just job seekers, fulfilling both institutional and market objectives.

SUMSNEPAL MODEL TO

Transforming Ideas into Economic Growth



Skill Development	Idea Validation	Enterprise Creation	Economic Resilience
Equipping students with necessary skills	Assessing ideas for local impact	Turning validated ideas into businesses	Strengthening community economy

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PRE-INCUBATION MODEL

Description of the model and its structure
Core objectives:
Skill development, Idea validation, and Stakeholder engagement
Breakdown of training modules

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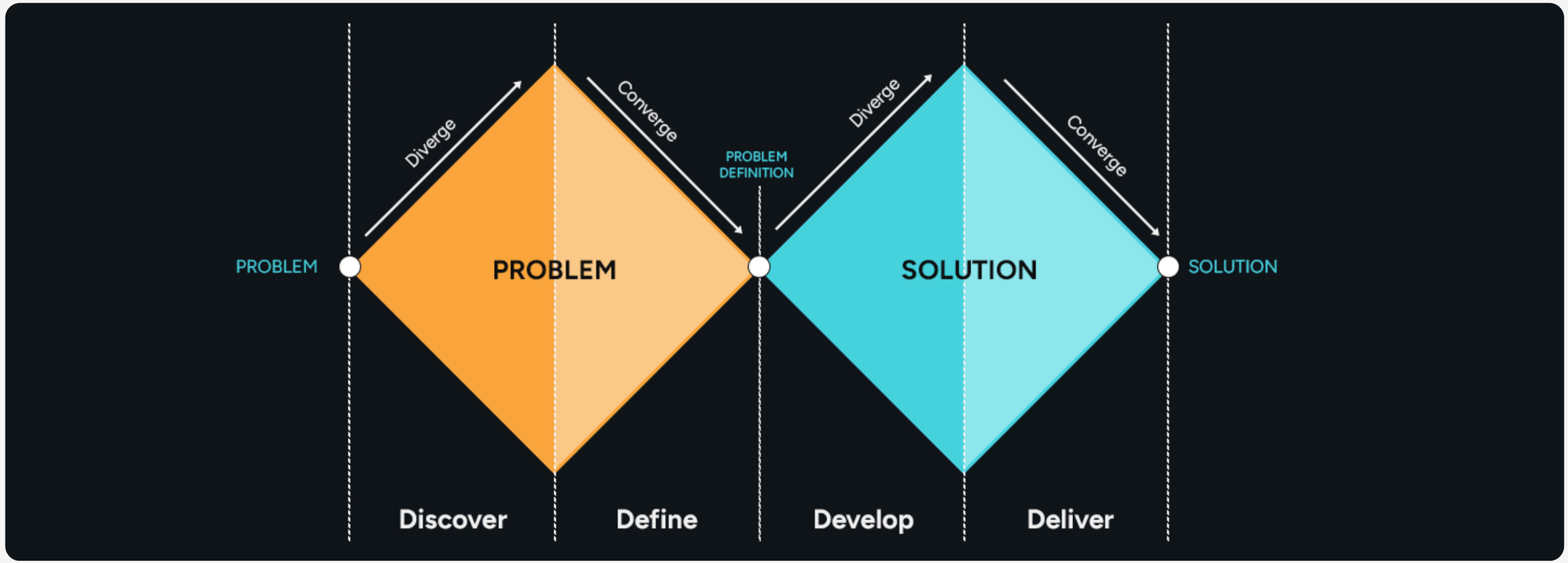
DESCRIPTION OF THE MODEL AND ITS STRUCTURE



The pre-incubation model adopts the Design Thinking framework from Double Diamond, a human-centered, iterative process aimed at fostering creativity, problem-solving, and innovation. The model is structured into five key stages that guide participants from ideation to actionable outcomes:

PHASE I

- **Discover**: Understanding the needs and challenges of the target audience through research, interviews, and observations.
- **Define**: Narrowing down insights to clearly identify the problem or opportunity to be addressed.
- **Ideate**: Generating a wide range of creative solutions to the defined problem.
- **Prototype**: Building tangible representations of ideas to test and refine concepts.
- **Test**: Gathering feedback from stakeholders and iterating on solutions based on insights.

This structure ensures a user-centric approach, enabling participants to develop solutions that are viable, feasible, and desirable.

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CORE OBJECTIVE

PHASE I

SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

- Building entrepreneurial, analytical, and communication skills.
- Enhancing creativity and teamwork to solve complex challenges.

IDEA VALIDATION

- Refining ideas through market research and stakeholder feedback.
- Testing feasibility to ensure readiness for real-world implementation.

STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT

- Facilitating collaboration with mentors, industry experts, and investors.
- Encouraging partnerships to scale and sustain validated ideas.

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BREAKDOWN OF PRE-INCUBATION MODEL

PHASE I

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IMPACT ASSESSMENT

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STATISTICS

TOTAL ENROLLMENT

24

FEMALE:MALE

79%

TOTAL IDEAS

5

TOTAL SKILLS

7

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01

TEAM A

Team idea not presented

02

TEAM B

Find Your Tribe is an app platform where we will be connecting our fellow college students.

03

BAZINGA

Bazinga Bites is a protein and meat bite, designed to target university students who want to fuel their bodies and minds with uni struggles.

05

APPLE

Clothing-Have your hoodie haven

04

DIVERSE

Bio kit bag pack

06

AROMA

Aroma Bags/Tote/bagpacks

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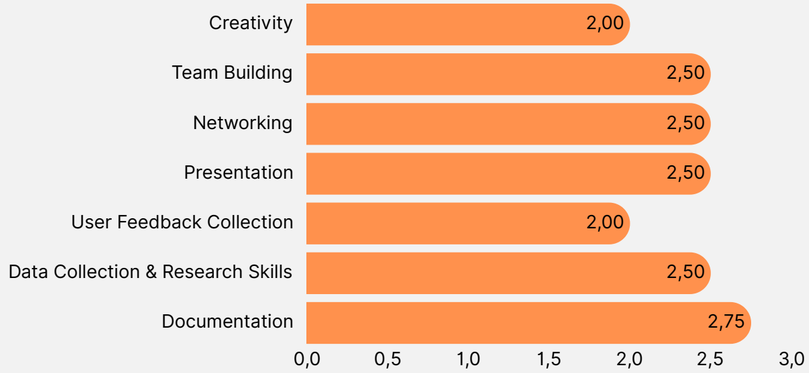
01

Team Skills GPA 2.39

TEAM A

Total assessed: 4/4

(3) (1)



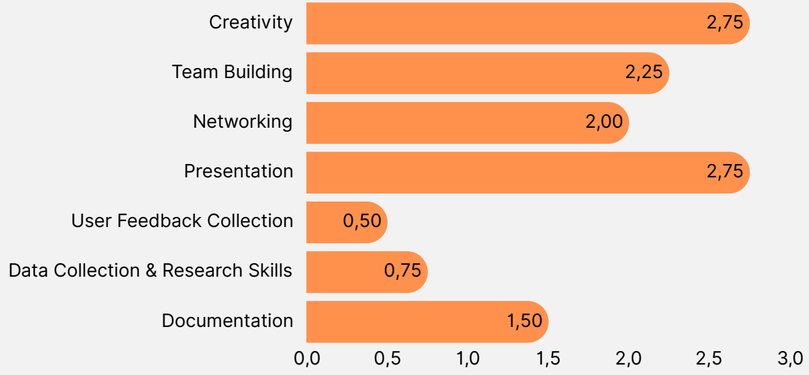
02

Team Skills GPA 1.79

TEAM B

Total assessed: 4/4

(3) (1)



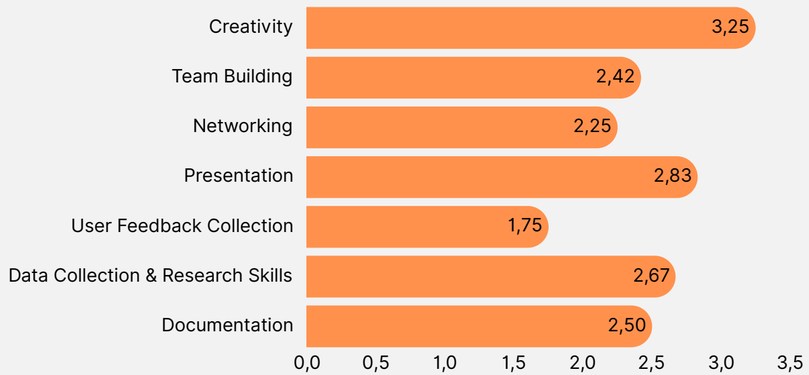
03

Team Skills GPA 2.52

BAZINGA

Total assessed: 4/4

(4) (0)



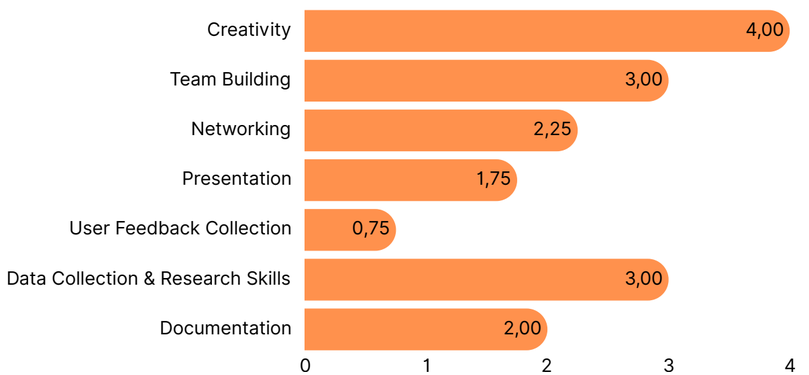
04

Team Skills GPA 2.39

AROMA

Total assessed: 4/4

(4) (0)



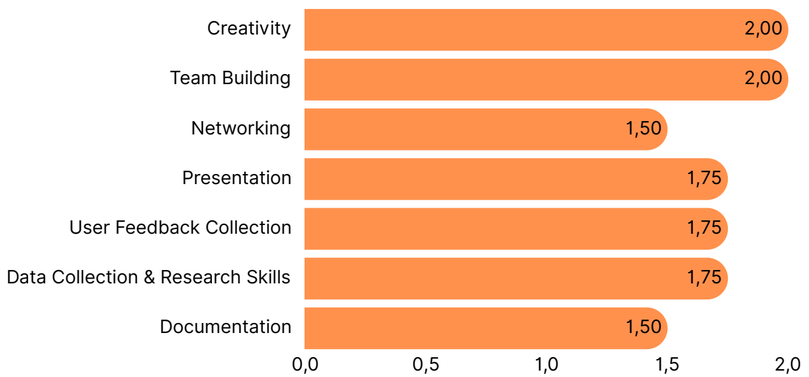
05

Team Skills GPA 1.75

APPLE

Total assessed: 4/4

(4) (0)

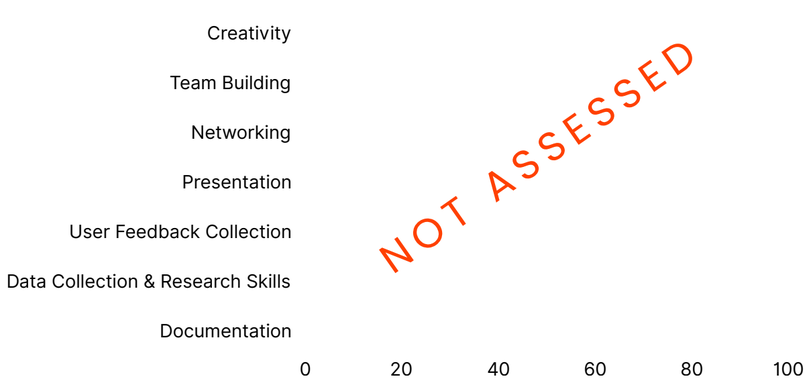


06

Team Skills GPA 0.00

DIVERSE

(1) (3)



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18/19
(94.7%)

1/5
(20%)

TOTAL ASSESSMENT
ENGAGEMENT

THE INITIAL ASSESSMENT & SELF -REFLECTION OF THE TEAM

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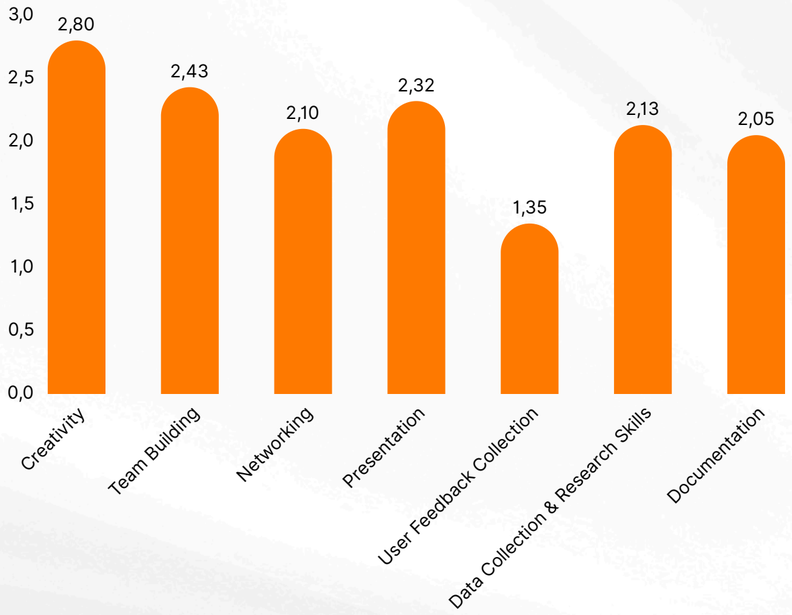
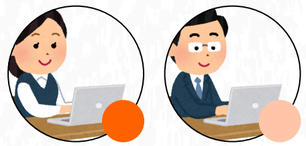
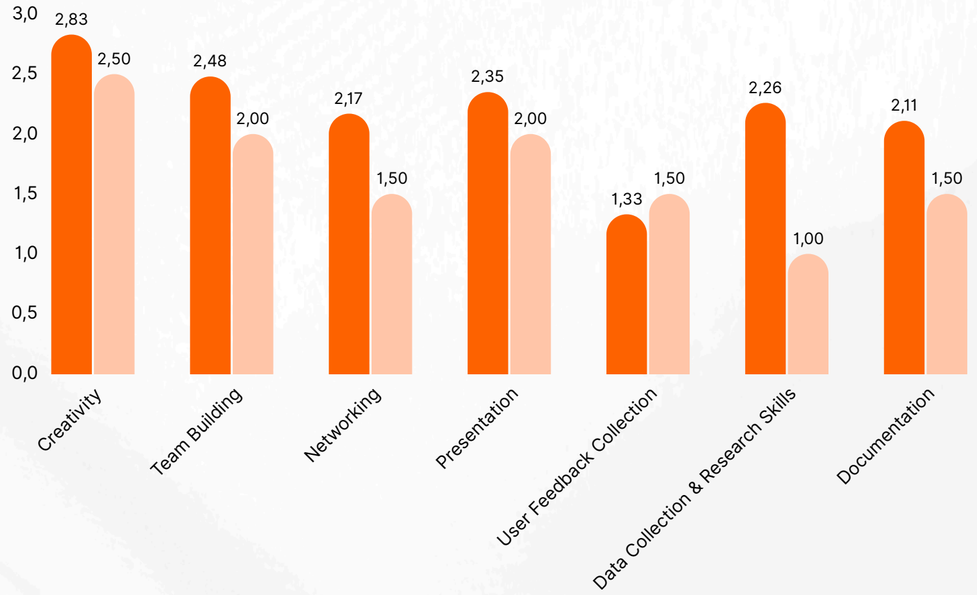
OVERALL SKILLS DATA





SKILLS GAP BETWEEN FEMALE AND MALE



TOP SKILLS

- 50% **CREATIVITY**
- 48% **TEAM BUILDING**
- 46% **PRESENTATION**

BUTTOM SKILLS

- 42% **NETWORKING**
- 27% **USER FEEDBACK COLLECTION**
- 41% **DOCUMENTATION**

The current findings are based on initial statistics gathered before active workshop engagement and reflect the platform's early introduction. As of December 4, 2024, these insights remain preliminary, as participants were unfamiliar with the process and expected outcomes. This initial assessment is insufficient for drawing definitive conclusions.

The nature of the platform and its objectives will likely evolve as students engage more deeply, gaining clarity on the workshops' goals and outputs. Over time, additional assessments and engagement data will offer a more nuanced and critical analysis. Conclusive results will be derived through ongoing periodic evaluations, ensuring the program’s full impact is captured and accurately analyzed.

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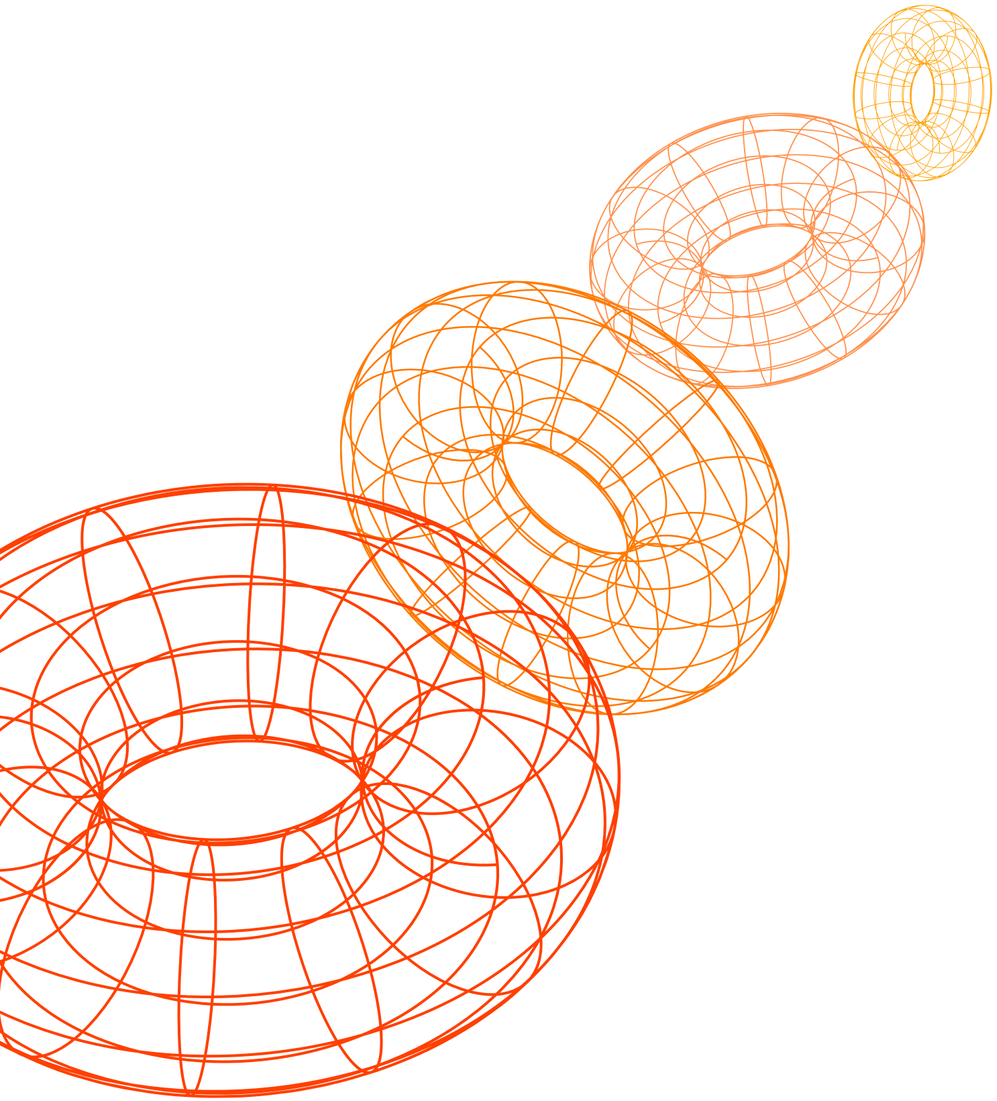

RESEARCH & ANALYSIS

CHALLENGES & OPPORTUNITIES

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KEY OBSTACLES IDENTIFIED DURING THE PRE-INCUBATION PHASE

MOTIVATION AND CULTURAL BARRIERS

Cultural Context:
The entrepreneurial mindset in Nepal is still evolving, and societal expectations often prioritize traditional careers over innovation. This limits the intrinsic motivation for risk-taking and creative problem-solving

Perception of Failure:
Cultural stigmas associated with business failure deter participants from actively experimenting and pushing boundaries.

TIME MANAGEMENT ISSUES

Academia-Entrepreneurship Imbalance:
Many participants struggle to allocate sufficient time to activities due to academic pressures and curriculum designed.

Lack of Structured Scheduling:
Inefficient program scheduling fails to synchronize with the participants' existing commitments, reducing engagement

SELF-INITIATION CHALLENGES

Dependency on Facilitators:
Participants often rely heavily on mentors or program coordinators for direction, stalling the development of self-driven learning and initiative-taking.

Limited Entrepreneurial Confidence:
A lack of exposure to entrepreneurial success stories and entrepreneurial environment results in hesitancy and passivity among participants

BUBBLE EFFECT

Lack of Real-World Exposure:
One of the significant challenges facing students is the disconnect between academic learning and industry relevance. This "bubble" often isolates students, leaving them unprepared for real-world challenges and the expectations of modern industries..

Disconnect from Industry Needs:
Participants often fail to interact with actual customers or stakeholders, limiting their understanding of market demands and entrepreneurship.

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CONVERTING BOTTLENECKS TO OPPORTUNITIES

01 LEVERAGING CURRICULUM

Leverage the project based curriculum and internship in the student's own ideas that would support their passion and growth.

02 MENTORSHIP CONNECTIVITY

Connect local and international industrial expertise to student team to provide the real world insights and preparedness including employability and entrepreneurships.

03 REFLECTIVE AND ADAPTIVE PEDAGOGY

Utilize self-reflection exercises to help participants recognize and overcome unconscious biases while developing skills across local and international domains.

04 STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT AND SUPPORT

Foster collaboration with industries to implement practicalities, policies and programs that emphasize inclusivity in entrepreneurial and technical education.

05 LONGITUDINAL TRACKING

Introduce metrics to monitor long-term impacts of the pre-incubation program in entrepreneurship and professional growth.

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STRATEGIC ROADMAP
ACADEMIA

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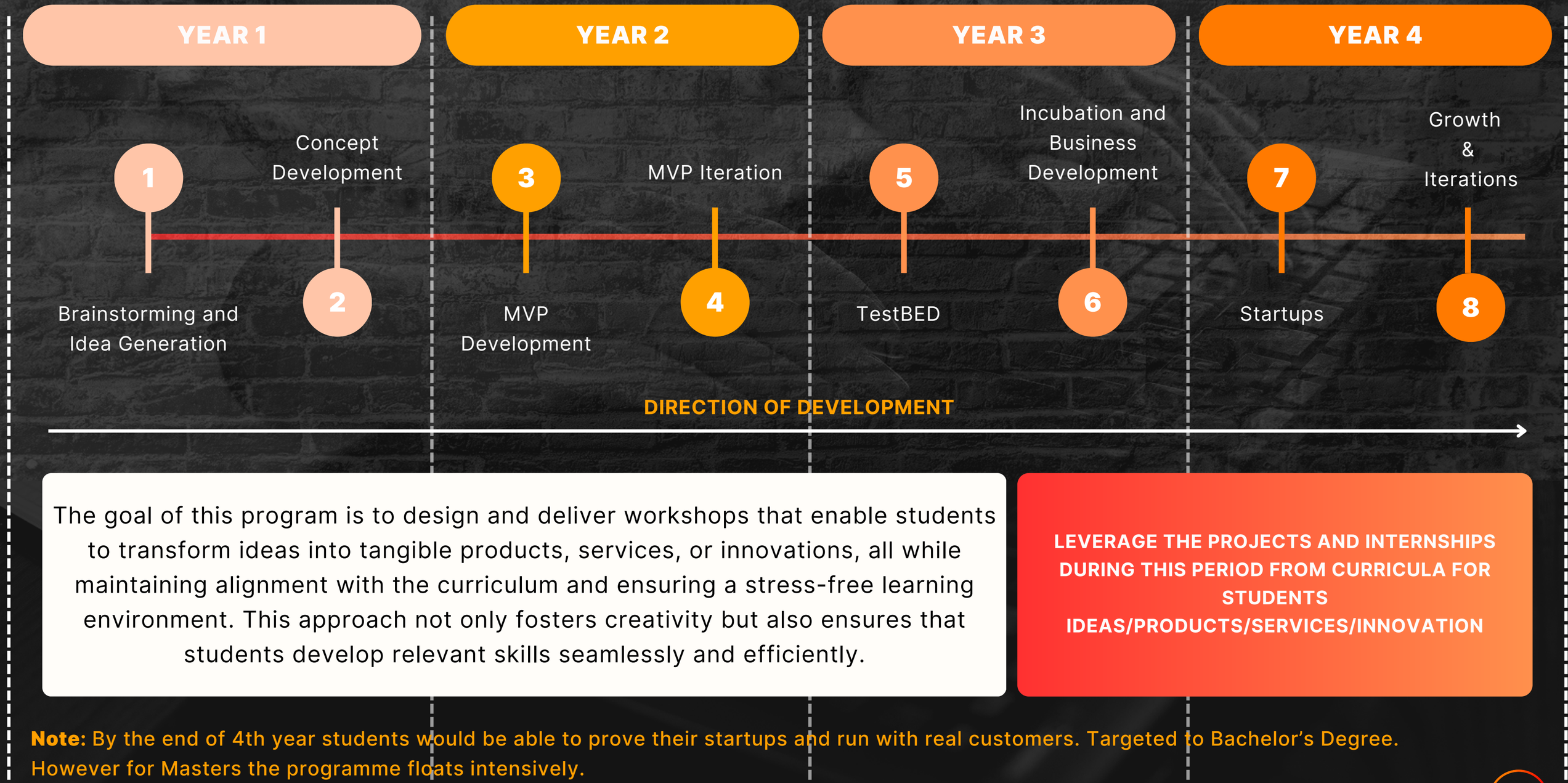

The goal of this program is to design and deliver workshops that enable students to transform ideas into tangible products, services, or innovations, all while maintaining alignment with the curriculum and ensuring a stress-free learning environment. This approach not only fosters creativity but also ensures that students develop relevant skills seamlessly and efficiently.

LEVERAGE THE PROJECTS AND INTERNSHIPS DURING THIS PERIOD FROM CURRICULA FOR STUDENTS
IDEAS/PRODUCTS/SERVICES/INNOVATION

Note: By the end of 4th year students would be able to prove their startups and run with real customers. Targeted to Bachelor's Degree. However for Masters the programme floats intensively.

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IMPLEMENTATION VALUES

IDEA REFINEMENT

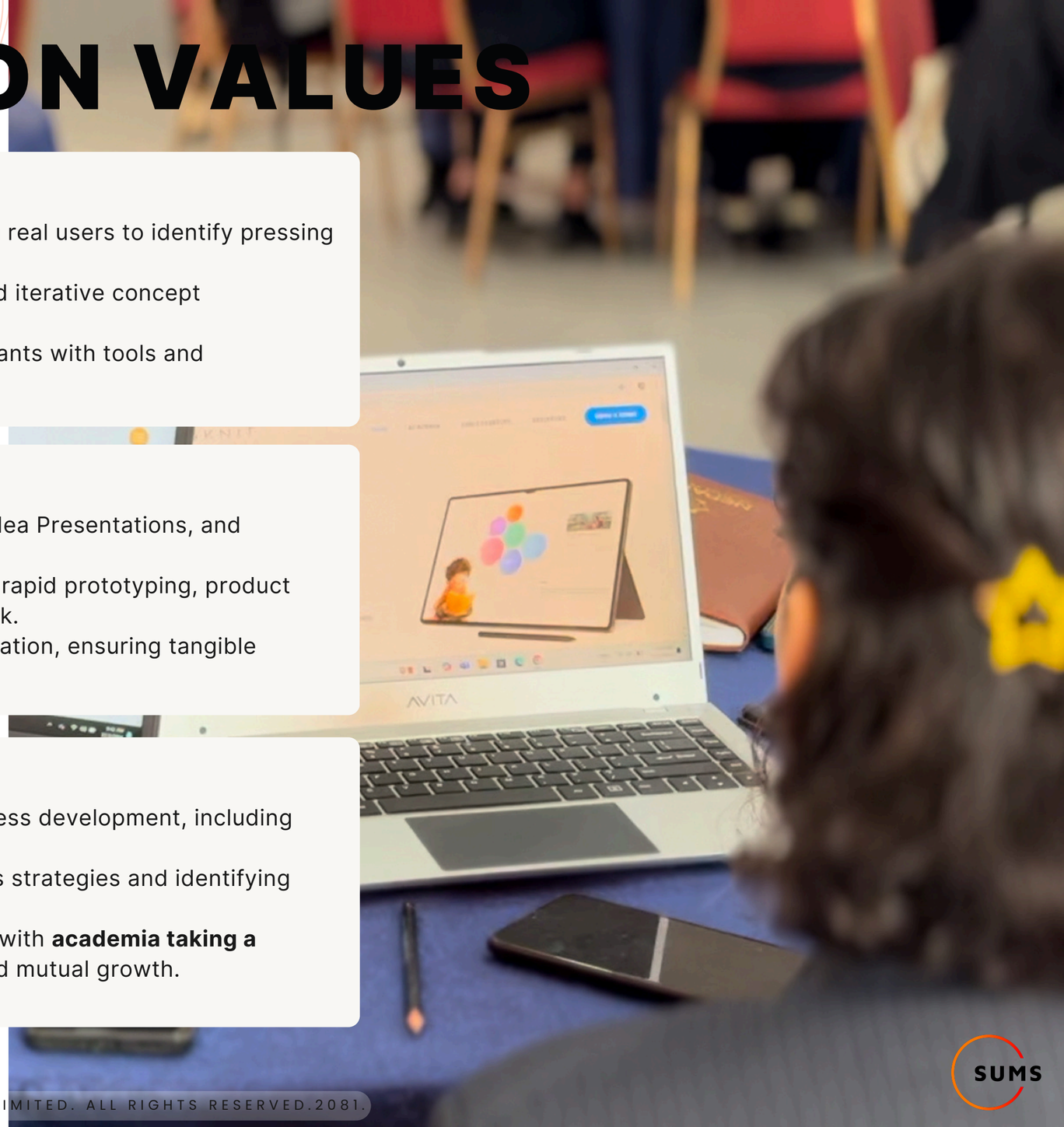
- Focus on problem discovery by engaging directly with real users to identify pressing challenges.
- Validate potential solutions through user feedback and iterative concept development to ensure feasibility and relevance.
- Foster creative problem-solving by equipping participants with tools and frameworks for structured ideation.

LIVE IMPLEMENTATION

- Conduct high-energy sessions such as Hackathons, Idea Presentations, and Pitching to bring concepts to life.
- Facilitate end-to-end solution development, including rapid prototyping, product creation, and iterative testing with real-world feedback.
- Transition projects from ideation to ground implementation, ensuring tangible outcomes that address identified challenges.

SUPPORT AND SUSTAINABILITY

- Provide comprehensive support for startup and business development, including connections to stakeholders and potential investors.
- Assist in market positioning by helping refine business strategies and identifying competitive advantages.
- Foster collaboration between academia and industry, with **academia taking a stake in startups** to ensure sustainable innovation and mutual growth.



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FINANCIALS & TIMELINES

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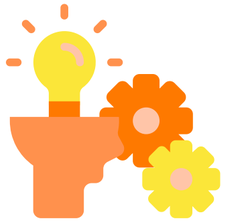
PHASE I

21 Hrs

Completed

TEAMBUILDING

4 Hrs



DESIGN THINKING

4 Hrs

RESEARCH

4 Hrs

DATA ANALYSIS

4 Hrs

PITCHING

5 Hrs

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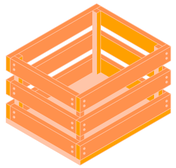
NEXT PHASES AND TIMELINES

VARIABLE TIMELINE



MVP

The Minimum Viable Product (MVP) is a crucial step in the product development process, but it **cannot always be constrained to rigid timelines** due to its iterative nature

DELIVERABLES:

- Iterative Validation Process
- Uncertainty in Problem-Solution Fit
- Market and Stakeholder Dependencies

Instead of imposing strict deadlines, an agile approach is better suited for MVPs. Timeframes should be adaptive, focusing on completing learning cycles and achieving specific milestones, such as validating a hypothesis or meeting critical user needs. This flexibility ensures that the MVP is both functional and valuable without compromising quality or feasibility.

TESTBED

A testbed is a stage in product development similar to an MVP but focuses specifically on testing concepts and solutions in a real-world environment with actual users to validate their feasibility, usability, and impact. Here's how a testbed operates and why it is valuable:

DELIVERABLES:

- Ground Level Validation
- Experimental Set Up
- Iterative Feedback Loop

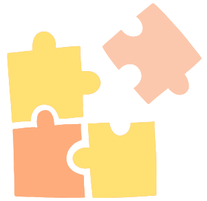
By implementing a testbed, organizations can ensure that their innovations are not only theoretically sound but also practically effective, leading to a smoother transition to the MVP or final product.

INCUBATION

21

WORKSHOPS

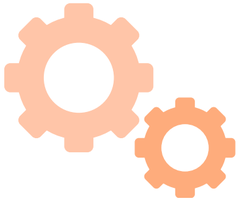
32 Hrs



SOLUTION DEVELOPMENT

CONTINUOUS ITERATION

- Product
- Services
- innovation
- trends
- technology



ACCELERATOR

BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT AND GROWTH

- Stakeholder engagement (e.g. investors, partners etc)
- Advisory
- International integration and so on

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THANK YOU

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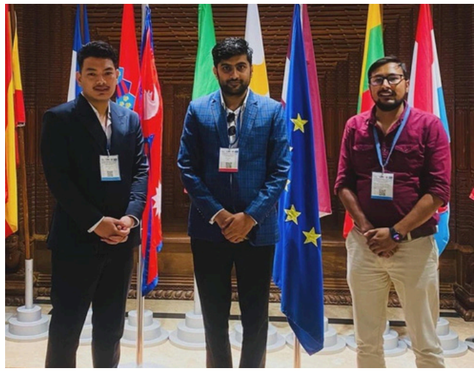

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